



HOME HEROES RISE IN PARIS

Nassourdine Imavov outclassed Caio Borralho while Benoit Saint Denis shocked Mauricio Ruffly, as French fighters lit up UFC Paris with **statement wins.**

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In a stunning display of skill and composure, French middleweight Nassourdine Imavov cemented his status as a top contender, defeating Caio Borralho in the main event of UFC Fight Night in Paris.

The unanimous decision — scored 50-45, 49-46, 49-46 — highlighted Imavov's calculated aggression and technical command. After a tentative opening round where Borralho found early success, Imavov adjusted his stance and controlled the rest of the fight with superior striking and ring generalship. By keeping the action on the feet, he landed the cleaner, heavier shots and thrilled the

Parisian crowd with a composed yet dominant performance.

The win is Imavov's fifth straight and his second in a UFC main event. More than just another notch on his record, it positions him as a leading force in the middleweight division. His knockout of Israel Adesanya earlier this year, coupled with this commanding victory, has set him on a direct collision course with new champion Khamzat Chimaev. Imavov's ability to adapt mid-fight, his crisp striking, and his calmness under fire suggest he has the tools not just to contend, but to eventually hold the belt.

The co-main event produced one of the evening's biggest shocks. French lightweight Benoit Saint Denis submitted the highly regarded Mauricio Ruffly, a fighter many

French fury: Nassourdine Imavov (left) connects clean on Caio Borralho in their middleweight clash at UFC Paris, igniting the Accor Arena crowd. GETTY IMAGES



Did you know?

Anderson 'The Spider' Silva began his storied UFC career in 2006, making an immediate impact in the middleweight division. He defeated Rich Franklin to win the UFC Middleweight Championship, which he held for a staggering 2,457 days.

During his reign, Silva recorded a record-breaking 16-fight winning streak, showcasing his unmatched skills. He defended his title 10 times in succession, dismantling elite opponents with a blend of devastating knockouts and slick submissions.

This stretch cemented Silva as a legend of MMA and one of the greatest fighters in UFC history. His reign ended in 2013, and his career closed with three consecutive losses in 2020, the last against Jamaica's Uriah Hall. In 2023, Silva was inducted into the UFC Hall of Fame.

considered a rising force with an explosive style.

From the opening bell, Saint Denis imposed his will. His relentless pace and well-rounded game smothered Ruffly's offence and forced him backward. Midway through the second round, the pressure broke through. Saint Denis dragged the fight to the mat, swiftly took Ruffly's back, and locked in a rear-naked choke.

The tap came just before the three-minute mark of Round 2, handing Saint Denis his second consecutive submission win this year. Beyond protecting his place in the rankings, the performance burnished his reputation as one of the division's most dangerous all-around threats, and he did it in front of an ecstatic home crowd.